

Army helicopter encounters cigar shaped UFO



Illustration by Michael Schratt and Tom Ruffin

Of the many UFO reports by highly experienced pilots, few are as well documented as the case which occurred on the night of October 18, 1973 near Mansfield Ohio. This significant CEII case involved a U.S. Army Reserve UH-1 helicopter, which had four crew-members aboard. The sky was clear, visibility extended to fifteen miles. During a return flight (around 10:55 PM) to Cleveland which originated from Columbus, Sgt. Robert J. Yanacsek alerted the other crew-members that a red light was rapidly approaching from the east (Lt. A.D. Jezzi was flying at the time of the incident). Its closure rate on the helicopter was estimated to be approximately 700 mph. Thinking the unknown light may be from a military jet, Captain L [REDACTED] grabbed the controls and performed an evasive maneuver by reducing power, and putting the helicopter into a steep dive. Then, the unknown object stopped and hovered above the helicopter. It was described by the crew-members as looking like a cigar shaped craft (approximately fifty feet in length), with a dome on top. It had a gunmetal gray exterior appearance, with a steady red

light on the front, and a white light on the back. The strange object made absolutely no noise.

Then a strange beam of green light could be seen originating from the bottom of the craft which illuminated the helicopter. Just minutes earlier, the helicopter was descending to an altitude of 1,700 feet. Now, as the strange craft departed to the west, the altimeter read 3,500 feet and CLIMBING at a rate of 1,000 feet per minute. Then, the crew felt a strange “bump”, and leveled off at 3,800 feet which seemed to signify the end of the encounter. Attempts by the crew to establish radio contact with nearby Mansfield Airport failed for a period of ten minutes indicating the presents of an unusual electro-magnetic disturbance. Ground observers also witnessed the mid-air encounter making this case one of the most credible within the field of Ufology. Sources: NICAP, *Uninvited Guests* by Richard Hall, *Strange Skies* by Jerome Clark